

exchange of fire. The *Governor Moore* twice rammed into the *Varuna* with her reinforced bow before CSS *Stonewall Jackson* sank the Union gunboat. The *Varuna* was the only Union loss of the battle. The *Governor Moore* was later shot up by several Union warships and, out of control, was sunk by her crew.

The strangest-looking vessel in the battle was CSS *Manassas*, a cigar-shaped ironclad with a ram and a single gun. Her curved armor performed excellently as she attempted a series of ramming attacks. The sidewheel steamer USS *Mississippi* and the sloop USS *Brooklyn* were both struck, and the *Brooklyn* suffered serious damage. The *Manassas* finally ran aground and was destroyed. The other Confederate ironclad, CSS *Louisiana*, was only able to fire a few shots—she was later scuttled to avoid capture. With the Southern naval force routed, Farragut had a clear path to New Orleans. He reached the city on April 25 and demanded its surrender. The garrison by then had been evacuated, leaving New Orleans defenseless, but the Confederate authorities refused to surrender, while Union officers and sailors who landed to take formal possession of the city were harassed. Farragut wisely waited, allowing feelings to cool down. After four days his marines were able to raise the Union flag over the major public buildings in New Orleans.

The forts, meanwhile, remained in Confederate hands, but shortly after the mortar bombardment was resumed on April 29, the Fort Jackson garrison mutinied. General Johnson Duncan, commander of the forts, decided that it was time to give in. As a result, when General Benjamin Butler's Union troops marched into New Orleans on May 1, they were unopposed. They had taken the city without seeing any fighting.